Lone Star Example Health System

System Policy FIN-201: Financial Assistance

Effective date: September 1, 2025

1. Purpose

Lone Star Example Health System is committed to providing financial assistance to patients who are uninsured, underinsured, or otherwise unable to pay for emergency and other medically necessary care, consistent with Section 501(r) of the Internal Revenue Code and applicable Texas law.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to emergency and other medically necessary care provided by each hospital facility of the System listed in Addendum A.

This Policy does not cover elective cosmetic surgery, bariatric surgery, and services billed by independent physician groups.

A list of providers who deliver care in the Hospital, showing which providers are and are not covered by this Policy, is in Addendum B to this Policy, available at https://www.lonestarexamplehealth.example/financial-assistance/providers.

3. Definitions

3.1 Household. For purposes of this Policy, the household includes all persons living in the same home who are related by birth, marriage or adoption.

3.2 Income. Household income means the household's total gross annual income before taxes and deductions.

3.3 Federal Poverty Guidelines (FPG). Eligibility is determined using the Federal Poverty Guidelines in effect on the date the application is received.

3.4 Medically necessary care. Care that is reasonable and necessary to diagnose or treat an illness or injury, as determined by the treating provider.

4. Eligibility for Financial Assistance

4.1 Patients may qualify for financial assistance if household income is at or below 400% of the FPG and the other conditions of this Policy are met.

Patients with household income at or below 250% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines qualify for free care, a 100% discount.

Patients with household income above 250% and at or below 300% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines receive a 75% discount from gross charges.

Patients with household income above 300% and at or below 350% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines receive a 50% discount from gross charges.

Patients with household income above 350% and at or below 400% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines receive a 25% discount from gross charges.

5. Other Eligibility Conditions

5.1 Assets. The Hospital does not consider assets when determining eligibility.

5.2 Residency. There is no residency requirement for financial assistance.

5.3 Insurance. Insured patients are eligible for assistance with deductibles, co-insurance and other balances after insurance.

5.4 Other programs. Patients who appear likely to qualify for Medicaid must apply for Medicaid before financial assistance is approved.

6. How to Apply

6.1 Application period. Patients may apply at any time within 240 days after the date of the first post-discharge billing statement.

6.2 Required documents. Applicants must attach the following documents:

(a) a copy of the most recent federal income tax return;

(b) the three most recent pay stubs;

(c) a Medicaid eligibility decision from Texas Health and Human Services;

6.3 Where to apply. Completed applications may be submitted:

- By mail to Lone Star Example Health System, Financial Assistance, P.O. Box 55020, Dallas, TX 75201.

- Online at https://pay.lonestarexamplehealth.example/assistance.

- By e-mail to assistance@lonestarexamplehealth.example.

6.4 Determination. The Hospital will notify the patient in writing of its determination and the basis for the determination.

6.5 Award period. Approved financial assistance applies to eligible care for 12 months from the date of determination.

7. Billing and Collections

7.1 Amounts generally billed (AGB). The Hospital calculates amounts generally billed using the look-back method based on Medicare fee-for-service and all private health insurers. The current AGB percentage is 28% of gross charges.

7.2 Presumptive eligibility. The Hospital grants presumptive eligibility for free care, without an application, to patients who are enrolled in SNAP, enrolled in WIC, or experiencing homelessness.

7.3 Screening. Accounts are screened for financial assistance before any balance is written off as bad debt.

7.4 Refunds. Payments made by an approved patient for eligible care in excess of the discounted amount will be refunded within 60 days of the determination.

7.5 Collections. The Hospital will not engage in extraordinary collection actions before making reasonable efforts to determine whether a patient is eligible for financial assistance. The Billing and Collections Policy is available free of charge.

Questions: call (214) 555-0200 or write to Lone Star Example Health System, Financial Assistance, P.O. Box 55020, Dallas, TX 75201.

Addendum A. Hospital Facilities Covered by this Policy

The following hospital facilities of the System are covered by this Policy: Lone Star Example Medical Center Dallas; Lone Star Example Medical Center Plano; Lone Star Example Medical Center Mesquite.

Lone Star Example Medical Center Dallas, 1200 Example Parkway, Dallas, Texas 75201 (Dallas County). Financial counselors are available in the admitting area.

Lone Star Example Medical Center Plano, 4500 Example Ridge Road, Plano, Texas 75093 (Collin County). Financial counselors are available in the admitting area.

Lone Star Example Medical Center Mesquite, 800 Example Town East Blvd, Mesquite, Texas 75150 (Dallas County). Financial counselors are available in the admitting area.

Each facility follows the eligibility criteria in Sections 4 and 5 without facility-specific changes.